

Consumable infrastructure

What goes into this category also fluctuates from family to family. There are some fairly predictable subcategories, however, such as oils, sweeteners, vinegars, seasonings, flours, grains, and other base ingredients. In short, these are items you use to put other things together, such as marinades, baked goods, dry mixes, casseroles, homemade salad dressings, dips, sauces, and other menu items. Obviously, some homes will stock up on such things as tofu, coconut milk, and curry powder, while others might concentrate more on frijoles and cornmeal, or perhaps cardamom and eggplant. This system works regardless of your preferred cooking style.

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3. Why buy in bulk?

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Emergency savings extension

Food storage and pantry stocking is a powerful part of your three- to six-month emergency savings plan that in my opinion should not be ignored. Bulk buying, if done diligently, can be markedly less expensive and also go a great distance toward supplementing that emergency savings fund in times of need. No need to take valuable time away from job hunting or caring for an ill loved one to shop for sales (or shop at all). You'll be ready to rock and roll

if you are stocked up for any occasion. Unexpected crisis situations really increase your personal vulnerability level, which for me is when I'm more likely to overspend due to lack of time and energy to spend on such things as budget grocery shopping. Being stocked up protects me from this.

Household harmony

In a nutshell, if you have the cash in your budget already, why go through the hassle of commuting, shopping, and waiting in line multiple times a month or week when you can skip the aggravation and deal with it once every couple of weeks or less? The peace of mind and ability to roll with the punches that comes with being well stocked is one of the greatest perks to stocking up. Youngest child forgot to tell you about tomorrow's bake sale? No problem. Your spouse has an unexpected case of the sniffles? Got it covered. Everything's on hand for those emergency batches of cookies and chicken soup.

Extra liquid cash

Eventually, the savings of bulk buying will carve out enough cash to really matter. You'll have enough to take advantage of larger up-front savings, invest more, or have a little more mad money. It's up to you what you do with it, but having more available liquid cash is always a good thing in my book.